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Section Title(S): Consanguineous Kin

San kin terminology is thoroughly described by Marshall (1959) and reanalyzed by Fabian (1965) in a componential analysis. Only the principles behind the system will be summarized here because although kin terms may be closely associated with marriage restrictions and preferences (Fabian 1965), they do not specify consanguineous and affinal relatedness, residence or personal attributes, the primary factors having bearing on reciprocity. Kin terms are applied according to two methods. First, kin are classified according to a generational system and then these terms are altered by a name factor which takes precedence. Marshall (1976) calls the latter the homonymous method. By the homonymous method relatives are given kin terms according to names they share with ego's spouse, parents, siblings and offspring. If a person does not hold a name in common with one of the members of ego's nuclear family, he may be given the term of another primary kinsman or  109 affine or may just be classified by the generational system. Terms for mother, father, son and daughter are fixed and are not altered by the homonymous method, nor can they be applied to anybody else. People sharing their name are given a generational term carrying the appropriate joking status (Marshall 1976). Sibling terms are unaltered by the homonymous method for those holding the biological position but may be directly extended to others who share the same name. Therefore, terms for a 'core', the nuclear family, are never changed by the factor of the name, because the names of individuals in this core form the basis for giving kin terms to others. Conceptually, what the homonymous method does is to take a term for a very close relative and extend it to a more distant one, symbolically bringing the person who shares the name into a close relationship. The one who shares a name with a person's sister is said to be 'like' his sister (note that the San clearly do not say that this person then 'is' his sister as the term giving and term receiving groups are kept distinct). The concept of generalized reciprocity among the San parallels this one when a basic parent-offspring form of reciprocity is extended to other relatives.

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